seen as running subsidiary to, but would instead be read harmonious with and complement, fundamental rights.

However, in other respects, the court's decision influenced constitutional doctrine long after it was effectively overturned by the provisional Parliament. The idea that reservations are an exception to, rather than a facet of, the right to equality enshrined in the Constitution persisted. This established and deepened the vocabulary of binaries – such as 'reservations versus merit' – that should never have existed. Seventy years on, Dorairajan continues to cast its long shadow.